Revenue Intelligence Dashboard — Findings and Recommendations

To: Sarah Chen, VP of Revenue **From:** Muhammad Irfan bin Zulkifle, Business Intelligence Analyst **Date:** 12 September 2026 **Re:** Unified dashboard covering marketing, sales and support

What was built

Your Monday morning report pull is now a single dashboard with three views: Marketing Funnel, Sales Pipeline and Customer Health. All three source systems have been loaded into one analytics environment and connected on the account identifier they already share, covering 499 closed deals, 2,240 marketing leads and 3,000 support tickets from June 2023 to February 2025. Filters carry across views, clicking a chart drills into the detail behind it, and clicking an account on Customer Health jumps to that account's deal history on Sales Pipeline.

Data strategy

I used the CRM as the **anchor table** — the table a combined dataset is built around, every record of which is kept, with the others attaching where they match. That choice follows from your brief: every question in it resolves to a deal or to a customer you have a commercial relationship with.

Three consequences are worth knowing.

Fifteen accounts exist in marketing and support but never in the CRM — 204 tickets and 150 leads. They are excluded from the combined view by design, but remain visible on Customer Health. One files 80 tickets with 31% negative sentiment, so this is worth resolving: trial users, churned customers, or a record-keeping gap.

Combining the sources creates row multiplication — the duplication that happens when tables holding different levels of detail are joined. Because one customer has many deals, many leads and many tickets, the combined table repeats each deal once per combination: 63,420 rows from 5,739 original records. Left unhandled this would inflate reported revenue 143-fold. Every figure in the dashboard therefore counts each deal, lead and ticket exactly once, and all currency totals are drawn from the CRM view rather than the combined one.

The quality review found two errors in the data dictionary, not in the data. Fifty-nine tickets have no sentiment recorded although the documentation states there are none, and seven identifiers documented as unique are not. Neither affects the dashboard. Ten checks were run across all three systems; the other eight matched exactly.

Design rationale

Marketing Funnel leads on cost per closed-won lead rather than conversion rate, because a percentage alone does not tell you whether a channel is worth funding.

Sales Pipeline reports win rate rather than pipeline coverage, because the CRM extract contains only closed deals. Average deal value is filtered to won deals; including the 184 lost deals at zero would report $1,417 instead of the true $2,245.

Customer Health is the view nobody is tracking today, and the one that combining the sources makes possible. Its scatter plot is the only visual showing marketing, sales and support on the same point.

Two things look like mistakes and are not. The funnel chart is labelled "Funnel Stage Distribution" because it shows where leads currently sit rather than a sequential drop-off — Qualified Lead holds more leads (848) than the stage before it. And the resolution-time chart is almost perfectly flat; that flatness is the finding.

A note on resolution times. The dashboard calculates ticket duration in whole hours, discarding the remaining minutes. At full precision the overall average is 58.7 hours; the dashboard shows 58.2. Every figure in this report uses the dashboard's calculation, so that anything quoted here can be checked on screen. The conclusions are unaffected — the gap between the fastest and slowest priority level is 2.8 hours either way.

How the natural-language layer was configured

Quick Chat was first tested with no configuration, scoped to the published dashboard. It performed better than expected: asked for our win rate and our best-converting channel, it answered both correctly. The reason is worth knowing. The dashboard's summary tiles — the large single figures at the top of each view, which the tool calls KPI cards, short for key performance indicator — are labelled in business language, so "win rate" already maps onto a named number. Good labelling is itself a semantic layer: a plain-English description of what each field means, laid over the raw column names underneath.

Where it failed was the question you care most about, described in the comparison below.

I then configured a Topic, which is that semantic layer made explicit. Two things went into it. **Custom instructions** define the terms in your words: what "win rate" means, that "converts" means reaching a closed deal rather than merely replying, that an at-risk account requires high ticket volume *and* negative sentiment *and* real revenue, and that deal value must be filtered to won deals before averaging. **Relationships** link the three sources on the account identifier, so the tool can combine support sentiment with sales revenue directly.

Key insights and recommended actions

1. Spend is concentrated in the channels that convert worst. Direct Mail converts 49% of its leads at **$9,881 per win**. Organic Search converts 0.9% at **$256,709 per win** — and takes the second-largest share of leads, 671, producing six closed deals.

Move budget from Organic Search into Direct Mail and Partner Referral for two quarters, and set a conversion floor below which a channel loses funding. Confirm first whether Organic Search is intended as an awareness channel measured differently; 294 of its leads sit at the earliest funnel stage.

2. Severity levels are not changing how fast tickets get fixed. Critical tickets resolve in **56.1 hours**; low-priority tickets take **58.9**.

Across a four-level scale the spread is under three hours, while critical and high-priority tickets carry the worst sentiment of any severity level — 28.0% and 28.7% negative, against 20.6% for low priority.

Set response targets — 8 hours for critical, 24 for high — and route critical tickets to a dedicated queue. This needs a routing rule, not headcount, and is the fastest improvement available anywhere in this data.

3. Your largest customers are your largest support burden. This is the question you could not answer before, and it is yes. Account revenue and ticket volume move together with a **correlation of +0.59** — a measure running from −1 to +1 of how closely two things track each other, where +0.59 is a strong but not absolute relationship. The ten highest-risk accounts hold **$182,814, or 25.9% of all closed-won revenue**. YieldMax Software alone files 334 tickets, 11.1% of everything support handles, against 5.8% of revenue.

Stand up a named-account programme for those ten, with a quarterly review and a named support contact. A quarter of the revenue base has no early-warning mechanism today.

4. Win rates vary 21 points across your six managers. David Kim's team wins 70.8% of 113 deals; Brian Nakamura's wins 50.0% of 92, on comparable deal sizes. The two largest loss reasons — No Decision Made (43) and Poor Product Fit (43) — are 47% of all losses, and both are qualification problems rather than pricing ones.

Run a win/loss review across the two lowest-performing teams, focused on qualification. Closing half the gap is worth roughly 17 additional wins over the 19 months measured.

5. Two things the data does not support. Average deal size for accounts filing more than three tickets in 30 days is **$2,242**, against **$2,272** for everyone else — recent ticket volume does not predict deal size. And Partner Referral deals win at **64.8%** against a 63.1% average; that 1.7-point lift is too small to act on. Both are worth stating so the team does not chase patterns that are not there.

Where the AI agreed with the dashboard, and where it did not

Ten questions were put to Quick Chat and checked against the dashboard and the source data. On most it agreed exactly. Four cases matter.

Configuration fixed a real failure. Asked for at-risk accounts before the Topic existed, it invented its own definition and produced a list overlapping the correct one by three accounts out of ten, missing 40% of the revenue actually at risk. Afterwards it answered correctly — four criteria instead of one, every figure matching source, accounts with no revenue explicitly set aside.

In two places it beat the dashboard. Asked whether our sales cycle is shortening, the dashboard chart — which groups deals by the quarter they closed — shows no trend. The tool grouped by the month deals were *created* instead, which is the right way to measure how long deals take, and found a clear decline from roughly 170 days to 40. It then flagged that recent months look artificially fast because only quick-closing deals have had time to close, and restricted its conclusion accordingly. That is better judgement than the dashboard visual encodes, and I would rebuild that chart. On campaign returns it volunteered the attribution caveat itself, explaining unprompted that spend is charged to every touchpoint while revenue is credited only to converters.

Configuration also introduced a new error. Asked which channel converts best, it gave the right answer before and after — but the configured version showed a table of lead counts, and four of its five figures were wrong, reporting Partner Referral at 148 leads against a true 807. The percentages calculated from those counts were still correct to two decimal places. The earlier version gave a percentage and nothing else; the configured version showed its working, and the working was fabricated. It became more convincing without becoming more accurate.

And in one case the numbers are right while the conclusion is backwards. Asked to compare resolution times, it correctly reported 56.1 hours for critical tickets and 58.9 for low priority, then concluded that the small gap "suggests critical tickets may be getting prioritized appropriately." The opposite is true: a 2.8-hour difference across a four-level severity scale means severity is not affecting how work gets scheduled. Every number is correct, the chart is correct, and the sentence on top argues against the cheapest improvement available in this data.

The pattern. Errors that are easy to catch announce themselves. The two that matter look exactly like good analysis: a confident conclusion with a table of workings underneath. Natural-language querying removes the wait for an analyst on straightforward lookups. It does not remove the need for someone who can tell when a correct number has been given the wrong meaning.

What I would do next

Reconcile marketing attribution against CRM revenue. The marketing platform credits itself with $1.13 million of revenue against $707,201 the CRM actually booked in the same period — a factor of 1.6. Neither figure can support budget decisions until that gap is explained.

Resolve the fifteen orphan accounts. 354 records are invisible to the combined view.

Add open pipeline. The extract contains only closed deals, so the dashboard reports what happened rather than what is coming. Forecasting was out of scope as you asked, but adding open opportunities is the obvious next step.